selves, and set the battle again in array in the place where they set themselves in array the first day. 23 [a] And the children of Israel went up and wept before Jehovah until even; and they [b] asked of Jehovah, saying, Shall I again draw nigh to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother? And Jehovah said, Go up against him.

24 And the children of Israel came near against the children of Benjamin the second day. 25 And Benjamin went forth against them out of Gibeah the second day, and [c] destroyed down to the ground of the children of Israel again eighteen thousand men; all these drew the sword. 26 Then [d] all the children of Israel, and all the people, went up, and came unto Beth-el, and wept, and sat there before Jehovah, and fasted that day until even; and they offered burnt-offerings and peace-offerings before Jehovah. 27 And the children of Israel [e] asked of Jehovah (for the ark of the covenant of God was there in those days, 28 and Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron, stood before it in those days), saying, Shall I yet again go out to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease? And Jehovah said, Go up; [f] for to-morrow I will deliver him into thy hand.

29 [g] And Israel set liers-in-wait against Gibeah round about. 30 And the children of Israel went up against the children of Benjamin on the third day, and set themselves in array against Gibeah, as at other times. 31 [h] And the children of Benjamin went out against the people, and were drawn away from the city; and they began to smite and kill of the people, as at other times, in the highways, of which one goeth up to Beth-el, and the other to Gibeah, in the field, about thirty men of Israel. 32 And the children of Benjamin said, They are smitten down before us, as at the first. But the children of Israel said, Let us flee, and draw them away from the city unto the highways. 33 And all the men of Israel rose up out of their place, and set themselves in array at Baal-tamar: [i] and the liers-in-wait of Israel brake forth out of their place, even out of [1] Maareh-geba. 34 And there came over against Gibeah ten thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and the battle was sore; but they knew not that evil was [2] close upon them. 35 And Jehovah smote Benjamin before Israel; and the children of Israel destroyed of Benjamin that day twenty and five thousand and a hundred men: all these drew the sword.

36 So the children of Benjamin saw that they were smitten; for the men of Israel gave place to Benjamin, because they trusted unto the liers-in-wait whom they had set against Gibeah. 37 And the liers-in-wait hasted, and rushed upon Gibeah; and the liers-in-wait drew themselves along, and smote all the city with the edge of the sword. 38 Now the appointed sign between the men of Israel and the liers-in-wait was, [k] that they should make a great cloud of smoke rise up out of the city. 39 [3] And the men of Israel turned in the battle, and Benjamin began to smite and kill of the men of Israel about thirty persons; [l] for they said, Surely they are smitten down before us, as in the first battle. 40 But when the cloud began to arise up out of the city in a pillar of smoke, the Benjamites looked behind them; and, behold, the whole of the city went up *in smoke* to heaven. 41 And the men of Israel turned, and the men of Benjamin were dismayed; for they saw that evil was come upon them. 42 Therefore they turned their backs before the men of Israel [m] unto the way of the wilderness; but the battle followed hard after them; and [4] they that came out of the cities destroyed them in the midst thereof. 43 They inclosed the Benjamites round about, *and* chased them, *and* [5] trod them down [6] at *their* resting-place, as far as over against Gibeah toward the sunrising. 44 And there fell of Benjamin eighteen thousand men; all these *were* men of valor. 45 And they turned and fled toward the wilderness unto the rock of [n] Rimmon: and they gleaned of them in the highways five thou-

[a] Josh. 7. 6, 7
[b] ver. 18
[c] ver. 21
[d] ver. 23; ch. 21. 2
[e] ver. 18
[f] ch. 7. 9
[g] Josh. 8. 4
[h] Josh. 8. 16
[i] Josh. 8. 19
[k] Josh. 8. 20
[l] ver. 32
[m] Josh. 8. 15, 24
[n] ch. 21. 13

[1] Or, *the meadow of Geba* (or, *Gibeah*. See ver. 10) [2] Heb. *touching.*
[3] Or, *And the men . . . battle: (now Benjamin . . . heaven:) and the men &c.*
[4] Or, *them that came . . . they destroyed*
[5] Or, *overtook them* [6] Or, *at Menuhah*

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sand men, and followed hard after them unto Gidom, and smote of them two thousand men. 46 So that all who fell that day of Benjamin were twenty and five thousand men that drew the sword; all these *were* men of valor. 47 But six hundred men turned and fled toward the wilderness unto the rock of Rimmon, and abode in the rock of Rimmon four months. 48 And the men of Israel turned again upon the children of Benjamin, and smote them with the edge of the sword, both [1] the entire city, and the cattle, and all that they found: moreover all the cities which they found they set on fire.

21 Now the men of Israel [a] had sworn in Mizpah, saying, There shall not any of us give his daughter unto Benjamin to wife. 2 [b] And the people came to Beth-el, and sat there till even before God, and lifted up their voices, and wept sore. 3 And they said, O Jehovah, the God of Israel, why is this come to pass in Israel, that there should be to-day one tribe lacking in Israel? 4 And it came to pass on the morrow, that the people rose early, and built there [c] an altar, and offered burnt-offerings and peace-offerings. 5 And the children of Israel said, Who is there among all the tribes of Israel that came not up in the assembly unto Jehovah? For they had made a great oath concerning him that came not up unto Jehovah to Mizpah, saying, He shall surely be put to death. 6 And the children of Israel repented them for Benjamin their brother, and said, There is one tribe cut off from Israel this day. 7 How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing we have [d] sworn by Jehovah that we will not give them of our daughters to wives?

8 And they said, What one is there of the tribes of Israel that came not up unto Jehovah to Mizpah? And, behold, there came none to the camp from Jabesh-gilead to the assembly. 9 For when the people were numbered, behold, there were none of the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead there. 10 And the congregation sent thither twelve thousand men of the valiantest, and commanded them, saying, Go and [e] smite the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead with the edge of the sword, with the women and the little ones. 11 And this is the thing that ye shall do: ye shall [2] utterly destroy every male, and every woman that hath lain by man. 12 And they found among the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead four hundred young virgins, that had not known man by lying with him; and they brought them unto the camp to Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan.

13 And the whole congregation sent and spake to the children of Benjamin that were in the rock of Rimmon, and [f] proclaimed peace unto them. 14 And Benjamin returned at that time; and they gave them the women whom they had saved alive of the women of Jabesh-gilead: and yet so they sufficed them not. 15 And the people repented them for Benjamin, because that Jehovah had made a breach in the tribes of Israel.

16 Then the elders of the congregation said, How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing the women are destroyed out of Benjamin? 17 And they said, There must be an inheritance for them that are escaped of Benjamin, that a tribe be not blotted out from Israel. 18 Howbeit we may not give them wives of our daughters; for the children of Israel [g] had sworn, saying, Cursed be he that giveth a wife to Benjamin. 19 And they said, Behold, there is [3] a feast of Jehovah from year to year in [h] Shiloh, which is on the north of Beth-el, on the east side of the highway that goeth up from Beth-el to Shechem, and on the south of Lebonah. 20 And they commanded the children of Benjamin, saying, Go and lie in wait in the vineyards; 21 and see, and, behold, if the daughters of Shiloh come out to [i] dance in the dances, then come ye out of the vineyards, and catch you every man his wife of the daughters of Shiloh, and go to the land of Benjamin. 22 And it shall be, when their fathers or their brethren come to [4] complain unto us, that we will say unto them, Grant them [5] graciously unto us; because we took not for each man *of them* his

[a] ver. 7, 18
[b] ch. 20. 26
[c] Dt. 12. 5; 2 S. 24. 25
[d] ver. 1
[e] Num. 31. 17
[f] Dt. 20. 10
[g] ver. 1
[h] ch. 18. 31; Josh. 18. 1; 1 S. 1. 3
[i] ch. 11. 34; Ex. 15. 20

[1] Or, as otherwise read, *the inhabited city* See Dt. 2. 34.
[2] Heb. *devote.*
[3] Or, *the feast*
[4] Or, *strive with us*
[5] Or, *as a gift*

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wife in battle, neither did ye give them unto them; [a] else would ye now be guilty. 23 And the children of Benjamin did so, and took them wives, according to their number, of them that danced, whom they carried off: and they went and returned unto their inheritance, and [b] built the cities, and dwelt in them. 24 And the children of Israel departed thence at that time, every man to his tribe and to his family, and they went out from thence every man to his inheritance.

[a] ver. 1, 18
[b] ch. 20. 48

25 [c] In those days there was no king in Israel: every man did that which was right in his own eyes.

[c] ch. 17. 6; 18. 1; 19. 1